SHADE STRATEGY

THE THREE BIGGEST MISTAKES

THAT KEEP

WINDOW TREATMENT RETAILERS UNDER

100K

PER MONTH.

INTRODUCTION

Before you buy more leads

It’s 5:18. You’re showing a customer how to use the remote when another homeowner calls about shades for her whole downstairs. The call goes to voicemail. By the time you call back, she’s booked with the shop that picked up.

If you’re trying to get to **$100,000 a month in sales**, look at what happens on a day you already have a job. There’s the call that comes in while you’re busy, the review you could ask for before you leave, and the van that’s been parked out front all afternoon.

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Letting calls go to voicemail

If you're spending money to make the phone ring, answer the damn phone.

I get it. You're on a ladder, or you're with a customer who needs your attention. That's when you need somebody else on the phone.

Thirty minutes feels quick when you're wrapping up an install. It's plenty of time for the homeowner to call the next shop. If you call back tomorrow, they've had all evening to shop around.

Put someone on the phone

Write down who has the phone each hour and who takes over when they're busy. Whoever's on can do other work, but the phone comes first. Give them access to the calendar so they can book a visit while they have the caller on the line.

Cover the phone after 5

For some homeowners, after 5 is when they finally have time to call. Check your log for missed calls in the evenings and on weekends. Start with the hours people already call. If it's just you, a live answering service can pick up when you're off.

How I answer the phone

Once you have somebody answering, listen to how they pick up. If all they say is “Best Blinds,” the caller has to get the conversation going.

> **“Great day at Shade Strategy. This is Cody. How can I help you?”**

Say it the way you’d greet somebody who just walked into your showroom. Practice it with whoever covers the phone.

Book the visit while they’re on the phone

Keep your service area and open appointment times handy. Ask what they’re shopping for and where they live. If you can help, offer two times. Get their name and callback number before you hang up.

When you miss a call

During the hours you cover, aim to call back within five minutes. Send missed-call alerts to the person on duty and their backup. If you get voicemail, leave your name and number.

I’ll get into what to say between hello and booking the visit in a follow-up guide.

Leaving without asking for a Google review

You've tested the shades and the homeowner's standing right there. Before you load the tools and collect the check, ask how the job turned out.

> **"How does everything look? Anything you want me to go over before I leave?"**

If they still can't work the remote, walk them through it. If something needs a second visit, tell them who'll call and when.

This is when I'd hand them the review card. Once you're out the door, they're back to making dinner or putting the kids to bed.

> **"Would you mind leaving us a Google review? You can scan this whenever you've got a minute."**

Ask everybody the same way. If they need help, show them where to point their camera and which link to tap.

Put the card in every truck

Keep a stack of review cards with the warranty paperwork. That way the crew has one in hand at the end of the job.

Get the code. On a computer, open your Google Business Profile. Click **Read reviews**, then **Get more reviews**. Save the QR code and copy the review link.

Test the card. Put “Leave a Google review” under the code. Print the card at the size you’ll hand out, then scan it with your phone. Make sure it opens the review form for the right location.

Send the link. Use the same link in your thank-you email so the customer can find it later.

Let customers choose what to say and when to post. Google bars rewards for reviews and pressure to write one on the spot.

Look up your own business

If someone saw your van and Googled your name, what would they learn from your last three reviews?

A truck nobody remembers

You bought the van. You pay to keep it on the road. Then you park it in a driveway for half the day and ask a little magnet to tell the whole street what you do.

Stand across the street from your van. Can you read the name and number from there? Can you tell what you sell?



Give the company name and phone number the most space. Say what you sell in words people use, like blinds, shades, and shutters. Put the name and number on the back, too. That’s what somebody sees when they’re behind you at a light.

What the wrap has to earn

Get a price for a full wrap and a three-quarter wrap. If you bring a trailer to every job, price that too. Ask the shop to mock up both sides and the back for your exact vehicle.

Look at the proof from across the room. Check that the name and number stand out and sit clear of the handles, seams, and wheel arches. If you add a QR code for people who see the van parked, scan it at print size. It should take them to a page where they can see your work, read your reviews, and reach you.

How many jobs cover the cost

Say the wrap costs **$4,000**. If a typical job leaves you with **$1,250** after materials, labor, and other direct costs, it takes **four jobs** from the wrap to cover it. Run the math with your own numbers before you sign off.

Ask how they found you

> **“How’d you hear about us?”**

If they saw the van, write it down when they call. Keep that note with the job so you can count how many of those calls turn into sales.

YOUR NEXT SEVEN DAYS

Find the first thing to fix

Use last week's call log, your last five jobs, and the van you drive most often.

01 Phone. How many new callers went to voicemail? _____
Who has the phone after 5? _____

02 Reviews. On how many of the last five jobs did we ask? _____
Who's putting QR cards in the trucks? _____

03 Vehicle. Can I read the name and number from the street? _____
What would make my van easier to read? _____

Call your own business from a number your team won't recognize. Try once during an install and once after 5. Listen to the greeting and see if they can book a visit.

If you want us to take a look with you, bring your call log, Google listing, and a photo of the van.

Book a free strategy call with Shade Strategy